

SHAKA ZULU

King Shaka Zulu (reigned 1816–1828) was a powerful warrior who founded a large Zulu Empire in southern Africa.

He is credited with inventing a stabbing spear and creating new battle attack formations. Both of these were used by the Zulus in their wars against the British.



ETHIOPIA ►

In 1889, the Kingdom of Ethiopia signed a treaty with Italy, handing over some territories in a bid to maintain its independence. In 1896, Italy invaded Ethiopia but was defeated by the African kingdom's military might at the Battle of Adwa. Italy retreated, and Ethiopia remained one of only two independent countries in Africa.



THE IMPACT OF COLONIALISM ►

The Europeans stripped African states of their political power and identity. They also disregarded the differences between the various ethnic groups, establishing their own boundaries and states. In some places colonists had to approve the rulers chosen by Africans, while in others they put in power rulers who would not challenge their authority, such as Daudi Chwa (right) of Buganda, in present-day Uganda.



◄ THE RESISTANCE

African empires fought hard to keep their territories. In West Africa, the female warriors of the Kingdom of Dahomey, called the Mino ("our mothers"), faced the French in 1890. Although known for their courage and ferocity, the Mino were defeated by the modern firepower of the Europeans.